Montclair Association, Inc.
P.O. Box 204015
Augusta, Georgia 30917

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AUGUSTA GA
PERMIT #143

Swim Team is a Goooo!

Let's Go Montclair



YARD *of the* MONTH



May Yard of the Month
The Grasers – 3305 Crane Ferry Road

If you have a suggestion for yard of the month please email the board at montclairhoa17@gmail.com

"We love it here.
This is our neighborhood."
Fred Savage, The Wonder Years

The Montclarion

Monthly News & Events from your Neighborhood Home Owners Association — May 2022

President's Message

I hope you enjoyed our spring this year, because summer is starting to roll in. There are only a few more weeks of school. For any families with kids or grandkids graduating this month congratulations and I hope you are able to enjoy the next few months before they move on to the next chapter in their lives. Oh the places they will go!

I wanted to thank all the volunteers that helped up at the pool last month. We were able to do a little makeover in the bathrooms with fixing the walls and painting. We also made new benches and some changing tables! Some of our green thumbs were able to add a little charm to our beds and flower pots. I also wanted to give a big shot out to my wife Meghan for spearheading the swim team this year as the parent coordinator. She is amazing and helps me with so much behind the scenes with the neighborhood. Below is a little info for anyone that is interested in joining the pool or swim team this summer.

The Pool will be opening on Friday 5/13 for Swim at your own risk. The lifeguards will start on Friday of Memorial Day weekend. Hours for "Swim at your own risk" are 7 am-9 pm. There is also a Facebook group for Montclair Neighborhood Pool- Augusta, GA. Please join there for updates and easy access to hours and closures.

Swim team will start on Monday 5/16. Swim team is open to all pool members. If you are interested in signing up your children, please head over to montclair-makos.swimtopia.com to register.

There will be someone available during swim team practice starting 5/17 Tuesday-Friday to help with payment in person and to get your codes and releases signed. Online payment for the pool and forms for printing are available on the website.

Greg

HOA Dues Reminder

Hi Montclair Neighbors,
It is that time of year again and this is a gentle reminder that if you have not paid your 2022 HOA Dues, they are past due. ALL invoice statements for unpaid HOA dues will be mailed out this month, May 2022.

You can now pay your HOA Dues Online!
Just go to https://montclairhoa.org/hoa-payment-portal/
Or use the QR code

Pay Dues Online
(Please have a Credit Card Ready)
PayPal VISA MasterCard

If you still prefer cash or check, you can send your HOA Payment to:
Montclair Association, Inc. • P.O. Box 204015 • Augusta, GA 30917



Come On In - the Water is Fine!



Scan QR Code to register and pay online or go to https://montclairhoa.org/pool-online-payment-portals/

UPCOMING BOARD MEETINGS:

JUNE 2ND @ 6:30 PM
WINDING WOOD PAVILION
(WEATHER PERMITTING)

Gardening IN MONTCLAIR

with Suzanne Thomas, Master Gardener

June in Montclair means beautiful green lawns, trees, shrubs—shade, beauty, plenty of clean air from the green plants. Thanks for all you do to keep Montclair beautiful, making it a wonderful place to live.

One of the things we look forward to every year at this time is fruit from our home orchard—hundreds of plums, figs, a few apples, and dozens of pears. From those fruits come plum jam in June, figs-in-honey in July, and pears—pears-to-eat, pear-sauce, pears-in-cranberry sauce. But something happened in January and February. We had night after night of temperatures in the 20's. That severe cold killed parts of the fruit trees—except the apple tree that loves cold weather. So this year there are scant plums and figs, a few more apples, but plenty of pears. What is the difference? Why did the pear tree fare well when the others suffered great losses? The roots of the pear tree have dug down deep into an underground spring. That is why the pear tree grew suddenly from a stick into a huge tree back in 2014. The water made the difference. Next winter, I will be sure to water the fruit trees when severe cold weather is predicted.

Weeds come with spring green up. The most prominent weeds evident in our neighborhood lawns are tramp weed, spurge, dandelions, plantain, thistles, dollarweed, and crabgrass. (See ***Weeds of Southern Turfgrass***, UGA Extension Service). How can we control weeds? First, mow to stop weeds from forming flowers and seeds that will spread to the surrounding area. Collect trimmings and send them to the landfill. There are multiple products that will discourage weeds, including weed and feed fertilizers. The most effective thing you can do is to spend an hour or two digging up the weeds. With a good weeding stick that looks like a screwdriver with a forked point, you can dig up a lot of weeds and let the preferred lawn grasses take their place.

This is a wonderful time of year to go for a walk around the neighborhood. Early mornings and late evenings are very pleasant. Wear light colored, reflective clothing to let drivers see you better. We still have some speeders.

What is the very best way to water your vegetable garden? Each year I try to find the best way. Our plot is an oddly shaped area next to the driveway. A round sprinkler drops water in the driveway. A back and forth sprinkler—well, never mind. Hand watering is not a good option. All of those deliver water on top of the plants not to their roots. So I am back to using the soaker hoses wrapped around hose guides. Water goes directly to the base of the plants. The hose can be covered by newspapers that block weeds. And the amount of water needed to satisfy vegetable plants is less than other methods require. Soaker hoses win every time.

Happy gardening. Enjoy June, the beautiful month.

Home Owners Association Board of Governors



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Important Contacts

Pool Phone
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Sheriff 's Office
(706)821-1080

GA Power
(888) 660-5890

Animal Control
(706) 790-6836

Garbage & Recycling
311

POOL UPDATES

We wanted to thank all the volunteers that helped up at the pool last month. We were able to do some updates and improvements in the boys and girls bathrooms with new wall factures in the showers and plumbing and painting. We also made new benches and some changing tables! Greg also wanted to give a big shot out to his wife Meghan for spearheading the swim team this year as the parent coordinator. She is amazing and helps him with so much behind the scenes with the neighborhood.





Save Bees

POLLINATOR DECLINE & HOW TO HELP OUR BEES





WHY ARE BEES IN TROUBLE?

Many pollinators are disappearing at alarming rates, especially native bees (such as bumble bees and solitary bees). Honey bees are also in trouble these days, with beekeepers reporting heavy winter and even summer losses.

The solution to pollinator health is not a simple one. **Pesticides are weakening pollinator immune systems,** leaving them more open to diseases and parasites. **Healthy food sources and places to nest are disappearing,** with "pollinator deserts" replacing once abundant wildflower meadows. People are moving honey bees and bumble bees around commercially, **narrowing their genetic diversity** and **spreading bee parasites and pathogens** in the process.

Habitat loss, acute and chronic pesticide poisoning, diseases and parasites, increasing intensification of conventional farming, and even the impacts of climate change are all taking their toll on bee health. **Many of our bees are sick, stressed, and undernourished.** ***But everyone can help save bees!***